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Real Easy English

Visiting places



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Georgie

Hello and welcome to Real Easy English. In this podcast, we have real conversations in easy English to help you learn. I'm Georgie.

Beth

And I'm Beth. You can find a video of this podcast and a worksheet to help you practice what you've learnt on our website, bbclearningenglish.com.

Georgie

How are you today, Beth?

Beth

I'm very well, thank you. How are you?

Georgie

Yes, I'm pretty good, thank you.

Beth

Good. So, what are we talking about today?

Georgie

Well, Beth, today we are talking about places. We'll talk about the city and the countryside and which we prefer.

Beth

Very nice. OK, let's start then. So, Georgie, if you were going to **visit** somewhere, for example, would you prefer to visit the city or the **countryside**?

Georgie

Are we talking about the UK or going abroad?

Beth

Let's start with the UK.

Georgie

OK. If I **visit** somewhere in the UK, I would usually want to go to the **countryside**. That's because I live in a city. I live in London, but I'm from the **countryside**, so sometimes I crave going out into a more **rural** area where I can see more green space, there's more wildlife. It's almost like you need to escape the, the busy **hustle and bustle** of the city.

Beth

Yeah. D'you know, I, I completely agree with you. Cities in the UK are great. There are some great cities, but I have **visited** quite a lot of them. And after a while the cities are all similar. Whereas the **countryside**, you can do different activities. It's really nice to see new places. I, a few years ago, I went to Kent and I had never been to Kent before because I'm from the north of England and Kent is in the south, and it was amazing. They had different kinds of buildings and like architecture on the farms. We don't have those same kind of roofs in the farms in the, in the north.

Georgie

Yeah, I also went to Kent last year. I did, but I went to the seaside because Kent also has a bit of coastline. Yeah. And yeah, I really enjoyed visiting Kent.

Beth

And the villages are so like cute and **picturesque**, we could say.

Georgie

What about when you go abroad? Do you, do you also visit the **countryside** in other countries?

Beth

I have done, but to be honest, I would normally go to a city if I go abroad, maybe the capital city or maybe a smaller city. But one of the reasons for that, I think, is the transport. It's so much easier to get a train or a bus when you're in a city. And you'd have to hire a car, I think, to **visit** a village or something like that.

Georgie

It's very true. Usually if you go abroad, you fly to an airport and the airports are usually closer to the city. And if you only have a few days in a place, it's easier to just stay in the city. It's also, I guess, easier to do lots of, like, activities in the city when you visit and try out lots of the local restaurants, everything is closer together so you can do more things.

Beth

Well, I'm just thinking if you're in the city you can, like, search on your phone for really good restaurants really easily. But if I'm in Italy, for example, and I don't speak Italian, it would be really difficult, I think, for me to find a good restaurant because I wouldn't know where to go. Sometimes it's the locals in the **countryside** that are able to tell you this. It might not even be on the internet.

Georgie

Yep. That's very true.

Let's recap the language we used in this conversation, starting with **countryside** land outside of towns and cities where there are not many buildings. We can also describe this with the adjective **rural**.

Beth

And **hustle and bustle**, the busyness and noise that you find in the city.

Georgie

We had **picturesque**, which means pretty or beautiful. We often use this to describe a place.

Beth

And **visit**, to go somewhere for a short time.

Georgie

That's it for this episode of Real Easy English. Go to our website to find a worksheet to test what you've learned. bbclearningenglish.com

Beth

And next week we'll be talking about gifts. So see you then.

Georgie

Goodbye.